



Google tablet incoming

According to DigiTimes, the Google 7 inch tablet is expected to come out this July.
<http://dgit.in/LHHpVd>

Halo's 'Destiny'

The next game from the house of Halo series developers is another series named 'Destiny'
<http://dgit.in/KCgNxK>

Travelzoom Cameras

all eight cameras in this segment employ plastic as their material of construction. However, it should be noted that none of them felt so. This isn't just because of the glossy finish like the one on the Nikon S9300, or the brushed metal look of the Sony HX20V, but mostly because the plastic is of extremely high quality, with both bulk and weight to give the cameras a sturdy build, without taking away from their pocket friendly nature.

We liked the Nikon S9300's design a LOT. We shot with it for a few days and noticed that we hardly ever used our second hand for operations.

One of the quirks we've always have with point-and-shoots has been the quality of buttons. Previously, they've all, for the most part, felt cheap, like they might just fall off at any point. With these cameras, we felt absolutely confident that the tiny pocks of plastic could withstand our abuse (think using it like a controller for a first person shooter).

PERFORMANCE

Now the fun part! In our real world test, we found that the Sony cameras produced the most well saturated images, even under the bright mid day sun, though at the cost of

some dynamic range. Canon's tended to expose more for the highlights, causing the shadow areas to be slightly darker, but the Panasonic TZ30 impressed us with very well balanced highlights and shadows, all while maintaining excellent contrast and color saturation.

We'd like to take out a minute to point out that while multiple cameras from the same manufacturer are different in many respects, the Canon SX260HS and Canon SX240HS are absolutely identical in terms of their imaging specifications. The only difference between the two is that the SX260HS comes with a built-in GPS chip while the latter does not.

For the macro test, we found that distortion at the minimum focusing distance (the lowest being 1cm on the Sony HX20V and most on the Canons (5cm). Interestingly, despite the disparity in the minimum focusing distance, the level of distortion on both the cameras is significantly low, almost negligible if we may say. The Nikon S9300 managed the same low level of lens distortion, although



Canon SX240HS

the pixel clarity was slightly lower than the Canon. Moving out of the scorching sun and into the studio, we turn up the ISO, lower the lights and see how these eight contestants fare. While ISO 200 and 400 yield the same image quality in terms of noise (and JPEG Artefact), its around ISO 800 that we start seeing differences in image quality and how the megapixel count on the BSI sensor measures up to the physical space. As it turns out, most of these cameras have more or less the same noise performance, however, the difference crept in with the amount of detail retained at high ISOs.

The sharpness test revealed that the Sony HX20V and the Canon siblings maintained maximum sharpness throughout the ISO range, but the Canons also maintained

more detail in the edges than the Sony. However, the Panasonic TZ30's detail retention was the highest, with the minutest of fibers being individually visible on the bear and the text on the wine bottle being visible (even the sub-title).

VERDICT

The "Best Buy" happens to be the Canon SX240 HS, it's simply the best performing camera of the lot and left us highly impressed. It matches the Sony HX20V in performance, while packing in a smaller price tag, making it the obvious winner for us. As it also happens, the Canon SX240 HS is the overall Best Performer from all the cameras tested (in both categories), edging the Sony HX20V by virtue of some minor, but important specifications, such as a faster shutter speed and a lighter body. So yeah, one camera walks away with two awards which doesn't happen very often.

Canon has the option to work with an external flash, which was a unique aspect among other cameras. While the SX260 HS dons the crown of Editor's Pick, the Nikon S9300 wins our hearts with its amazing ergonomics, but also the sturdy build and excellent performance.

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